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APPS



**Spotify expands
audiobook access to
family plan members for
the first time**

Audiobooks+ for Plan Members

Unlock audiobooks for plan members

Add-on starting at €xx/month

Add to subscription

Spotify on Thursday [announced](#) an expansion of its premium audiobooks service, with two new plans that offer additional listening hours to subscribers, and allow other family members to access the service.

The options are currently only available for Spotify Premium users in the U.K., Australia, New Zealand, France, Belgium, the Netherlands, Luxembourg, Germany, Austria, Switzerland, and Liechtenstein, following initial tests in Ireland and Canada.

What you'll get could already purchase 15 hours of listening [as a standalone offering](#) through an Audiobooks Access Plan, but these additions make it possible for those in other markets to customize their access to their own needs.

The [first new plan](#), Audiobooks+, offers Premium subscribers, or those who manage the household's Family or Duo plan, to add 15 hours of listening every month on top of the base plan. Today, Spotify's Premium plans include 15 hours of audiobook listening, so this new plan doubles that offering, ensuring subscribers can get through longer books or even a couple of shorter ones in the month.

The other new plan, Audiobooks+ for Plan Members, will be an even more welcome addition for those who want to share access to audiobooks: Members on Premium Family and Duo plans will be

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able to access 15 hours of monthly audiobook listening, too.

Similar plans will arrive later in the U.S., Spotify told TechCrunch.

To use the feature, plan members will first request audiobook access from their plan manager, who purchases the new add-on. Members can also later buy a one-time top-up of 10 hours if they run out of listening time before the next billing cycle.

Spotify did not share the pricing for the new options, as they vary by market. A spokesperson said that users in those markets can visit the [Spotify.com/audiobooks](https://spotify.com/audiobooks) page to learn more.

One major publisher, HarperCollins, [noted in December](#) that Spotify was working to bring audiobooks to other family members on shared plans. At a conference, HarperCollins CEO Brian Murray said that the market had potential for further growth as Spotify was at the time working out a “technical issue” with family plans that limited audiobooks to the plan’s credit card holder.

The streaming service sees AI as another opportunity for expansion, [saying](#) in last quarter’s earnings that it was working with ElevenLabs to get more books narrated, including translating texts from English to other languages.

Spotify’s catalog now spans [375,000 audiobooks](#). However, buying audiobook hours instead of purchasing titles, as with Amazon’s Audible, lets users experiment more with what they may want to listen to, as they won’t waste money on books they end up not liking and choose not to finish.

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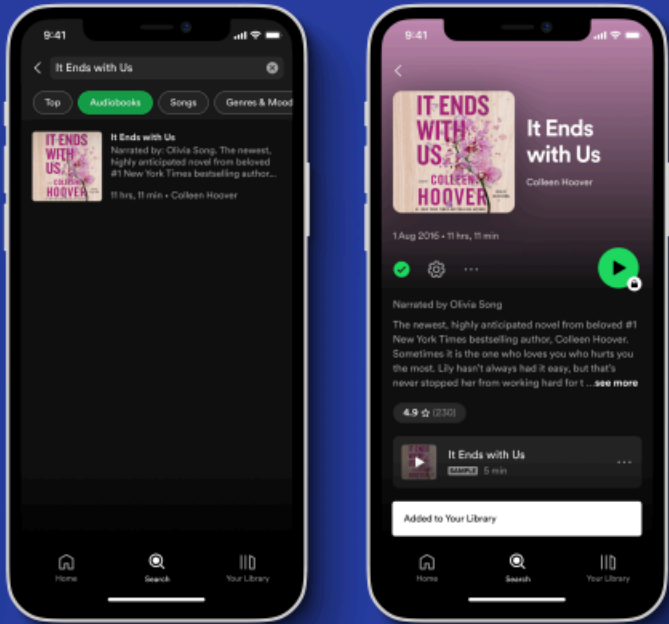
Sarah Perez

Consumer News Editor | X   @ in

Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

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Spotify launches a \$9.99/mo standalone audiobooks service for its free users

Sarah Perez — 6:29 AM PST · March 1, 2024

After adding 15 hours of free audiobooks listening

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a Spotify Premium subscription starts at \$10.99 per month for an individual plan — only a dollar more than the audiobooks-only plan. However, the move could allow Spotify to upsell audiobooks to customers who aren't as interested in its music service, or who regularly use another app for that. It could also make the Premium product look more compelling.

In addition, the move gives Spotify a way to compete with Amazon-owned audiobooks giant Audible as it introduces a different model for audiobook listening. Instead of paying for Audible's \$14.95 per month subscription that offers one credit to buy a title from its larger collection including best sellers and new releases, users could pay Spotify \$9.99 per month for a certain number of hours. Fifteen hours is fairly generous, as it often encompasses more listening time than one audiobook alone, if not two shorter books.

The company today also offered an update on the interest that free users have for audiobooks, noting that since launching audiobooks for its Premium subscribers, it's seen a 45% increase in free users

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searching for and interacting with audiobook content each day.

In its most recent quarter, Spotify saw the [second biggest quarterly gain in users](#) in its company history, reaching over 600 million monthly active users, and over 236 million paid subscribers — up 15% year-over-year, despite raising prices in the U.S. from \$9.99 to \$10.99 per month. It also said that it became the No. 2 provider of audiobooks, behind Audible, but noted it was still too early to say what impact the service was having on subscriber momentum and other aspects of its business.

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REGISTER NOW

Spotify brings 15 hours of monthly audiobook listening to Premium subscribers in the US



Roughly a month after Spotify announced that a selection of audiobooks would become a part of its Premium subscription, the company is today expanding the service to U.S. users for the first time. Subscribers will now have access to 15 hours of audiobook listening time per month across a catalog that includes 200,000 titles — ... [Continue reading](#)

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Sarah Perez

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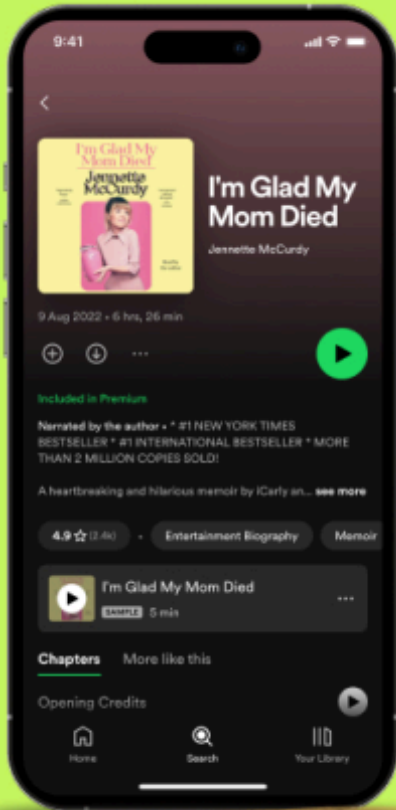
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Spotify brings its audiobooks perk for Premium users to Canada, Ireland and New Zealand

Aisha Malik — 9:13 AM PDT · April 2, 2024

Spotify announced on Tuesday that it's bringing its free audiobooks perk to Canada, Ireland and New Zealand. Users in these markets will be able to access 15 hours of free monthly audiobook listening time. Spotify also announced that it's expanding its audiobooks catalog from 200,000 to 250,000 titles. The perk is already available in the U.S., U.K. and Australia.

The expansion comes two months after Spotify said its audiobooks service is the second-largest audiobook provider behind Amazon-owned Audible. Spotify says users have listened to more than 150,000 titles since the free service's launch last November.

Audiobooks can be found in the Home feed of the Spotify app or via the search tab. Any audiobook marked as "Included in Premium" can be listened to with a Spotify Premium subscription. You can track your listening hours in the settings of your Spotify app. If you run out of listening hours, you can

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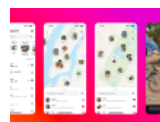
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purchase additional 10-hour allocations for CAD \$14.99, IRE €12.99 and NZD \$19.99.

Spotify recently launched [a \\$9.99 per month](#) plan that allows its free users to access its audiobooks collection in the U.S. The plan, which includes 15 hours of listening, gives Spotify a way to compete with Audible by targeting users who aren't as interested in its music service. While Audible's \$14.95 per month subscription gives users one credit to buy a title, Spotify's \$9.99 plan allows users to listen to 15 hours across its catalog, which is often enough time to listen to more than one audiobook.

Spotify's Audiobooks will get their own 'Countdown Pages' to tease upcoming new releases



Spotify is enhancing its audiobooks streaming service with a feature that may be familiar to the app's music consumers: Countdown Pages. These

YouTube-like Countdown Pages were launched alongside other new additions for Spotify's artists last year, offering a dedicated space on artists' profiles where a timer could count down to a new release. Now, that ... [Continue reading](#)

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Consumer News Reporter |

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporte...

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